Daily Economic Briefing

Friday 23 October 2026 | Window: Wed 21 Oct 2026 20:00 ET – Thu 22 Oct 2026 20:20 ET (Thu 22 Oct close/AH, the window's one NYSE session) | Research cutoff Thu 22 Oct 2026, 20:20 ET | Edition 48

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- Edition 47 flagged a genuine, unresolved dispute for Meta's Wednesday 21 Oct after-hours move (one aggregator showed both +2.16% and +4% for the same quote). Thursday 22 Oct's regular session gave an unambiguous close (-6.98%), which supersedes the AH dispute as the operative figure — see Section 2.
- Neither AP's wire nor Reuters' updated wrap was indexed/fetchable for Thursday 22 Oct by this edition's cutoff. Index levels below use stockanalysis.com's ETF-proxy data cross-checked against a direct-index snapshot (fool.com); both reconcile tightly against Wednesday's logged closes — see Section 1.
- LME copper's primary source (westmetall.com) is unreachable this edition (expired TLS certificate, site now serves a generic parking page) — the first break in a 26-edition clean streak. COMEX copper futures (Investing.com) are used as a disclosed substitute; the level is not directly comparable to an LME quote — see Section 4.
- The vendor-retroactive-revision trap recurred again: gold and silver's own previously-logged Wednesday 21 Oct closes were both revised (again) on refetch from the same vendor — see Section 4.
- A clean, working whitehouse.gov URL for US government funding status was re-established this edition, replacing the one that broke at edition 47 — see Section 3.
- Bank of Japan's Oct 29-30 meeting date was re-confirmed via an explicit dedicated direct fetch, closing a 3-edition-open sourcing thread. The exact numeric policy rate remains unconfirmed via a readable primary source for a 4th straight edition — see Section 3.
- Riksbank's and the ECB's current policy rates could not be freshly verified this edition (a 404 and an internally conflicting figure, respectively). Riksbank is carried in the table from secondary corroboration; ECB is excluded from the table this edition — see Section 3 and Annex A.

60-second read

1. A tech-led rotation, not a broad selloff: S&P 500 -1.21% to 7,663.43, Nasdaq Composite approx. -2.58% to 26,014.86, Nasdaq-100 -2.86%, while the Dow held +0.02% to 52,867.98 and the Russell 2000 +0.07% — driven by Meta's post-earnings reversal and a 3.29% Technology-sector decline, cushioned by Consumer Staples (+3.31%) and Utilities (+2.07%) on defensive rotation plus a strong industrials/staples earnings cluster.
2. Meta's after-hours dispute is resolved by Thursday's close: -6.98% to $648.85, unambiguous, despite a revenue beat to $64.60bn — GAAP EPS $3.83 (adjusted $7.40 ex. a $9.89bn one-time teen-safety-settlement charge) and a capex guide raised to $135-145bn with no 2027 revenue guidance drove the market's read as an AI-capex-anxiety trigger, dragging Nvidia -4.40% and Alphabet -3.15% alongside it.
3. VIX jumped 14.09% to 19.03, its sharpest one-day pop in weeks, while the term structure stayed in contango (VIX9D 18.86 < VIX 19.03 < VIX3M 20.12 < VIX6M 21.66) — consistent with an event-driven vol spike rather than systemic stress.
4. Fed-odds moved more dovish into next week's blackout-period decision: DeFi Rate's blended aggregator put Oct 28 hold odds at approx. 94% (up from approx. 88% last edition), with December's hike odds easing slightly to approx. 72-77% (the source's own December sub-tables remain internally inconsistent).
5. A cross-asset divergence this report could not pin to a single catalyst: oil jumped (WTI +2.19% to $99.28, Brent +4.00% to $113.17) and Treasury yields fell notably (10-year -17bp to 4.96%) even as gold (-2.69%) and silver (-5.37%) sold off sharply.

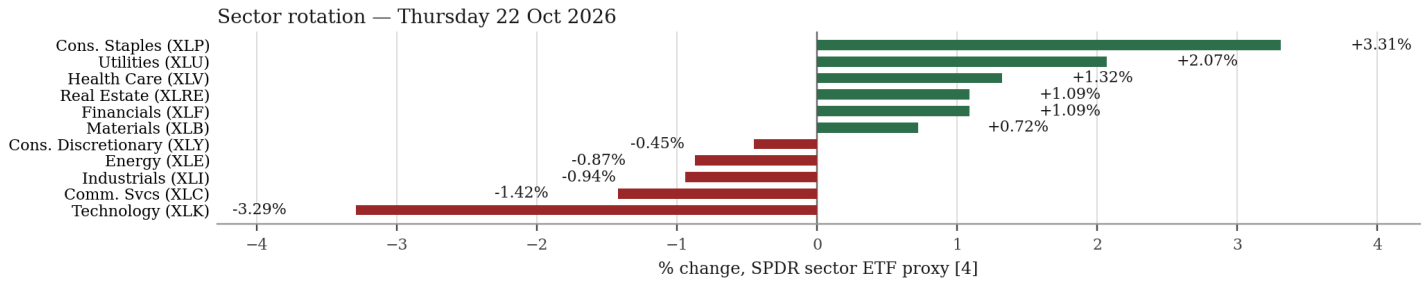
1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow Jones	Nasdaq Comp.	Russell 2000	VIX	10-yr yield
7,663.43	**52,867.98**	**26,014.86**	**2,782.97**	**19.03**	**4.96%**
-1.21%	+0.02%	-2.58%	+0.07%	+14.09%	-17bp

DXY	WTI crude	Gold
101.57	**$99.28**	**$4,038.35**
-0.21%	+2.19%	-2.69%

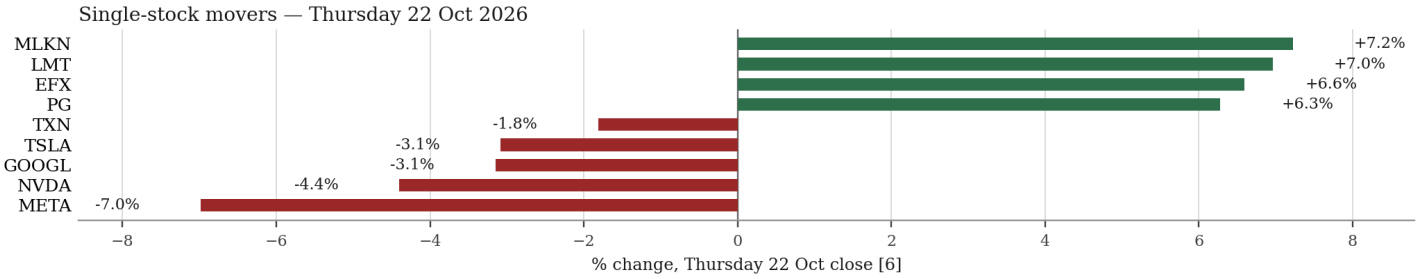
A genuine rotation session rather than a broad risk-off day: the S&P 500 and Nasdaq fell hard on a Technology-sector drawdown led by Meta's post-earnings reversal, while the Dow and Russell 2000 held roughly flat, cushioned by a strong industrials/staples earnings slate (Lockheed Martin, Procter & Gamble) and a defensive bid into Staples and Utilities. Neither AP nor Reuters had an indexed, fetchable wire for Thursday 22 Oct by this edition's cutoff; the index levels above are ETF-proxy derived (stockanalysis.com: SPY, DIA, ONEQ, IWM) cross-checked against a direct-index snapshot (fool.com: S&P and Dow) and against Wednesday's logged closes (edition 47) — both cross-checks reconciled tightly. Nasdaq Composite and Russell 2000 in particular are ETF-proxy-derived point levels, not direct index snapshots (Annex A).[1][2][7]

2. Equities and earnings



All 11 SPDR sector ETFs fetched directly: 6 of 11 closed higher (official NYSE/Nasdaq breadth remains unobtainable; this is the standing proxy). Consumer Staples (+3.31%) led on Procter & Gamble's beat; Technology (-3.29%) lagged by a wide margin on Meta's reversal and chip-complex weakness (Nvidia -4.40%, Texas Instruments -1.81%). Communication Services fell a milder -1.42% despite housing both Meta and Alphabet (-3.15%), partially offset by other constituents.[4]

Single-stock movers



Ticker	Move	Driver
MLKN	+7.22%	Rebounded from Wednesday's -4.91% decline; no new Thursday-specific catalyst found.[6]
LMT	+6.96%	Q3 2026 beat: sales +11% to $20.7bn, EPS $7.97, record $292.0bn backlog incl. a $52.5bn PAC-3 MSE award.[3][6]
EFX	+6.59%	Extended an unexplained rally for a third straight session (+11.33% Tue, flat Wed, +6.59% Thu on an in-line print and slightly cut guidance); no catalyst found — open thread.[6]
PG	+5.58% to +6.28%	FY2027 Q1 beat: organic sales +4%, net sales $23.3bn, all 10 categories/6 regions grew, core EPS $2.00; close-to-close and the page's own adjusted-prior-close calculation disagree by 0.7pt, reported as a range.[3][6]
META	-6.98%	Revenue beat to $64.60bn overshadowed by a $9.89bn one-time charge tied to Meta's Aug 2026 52-state teen-safety settlement (GAAP EPS $3.83 vs. adjusted $7.40); 2026 capex guide raised to $135-145bn with no 2027 revenue guidance — Thursday's close resolves edition 47's disputed Wed AH move.[3][6][7]
NVDA	-4.40%	Fell with the broader chip/AI-hardware complex alongside Meta's capex-anxiety trigger; no single dated catalyst specific to Nvidia found.[6]
GOOGL	-3.15%	Declined ahead of its own earnings report, consistent with the session's AI-capex-anxiety theme; no dated catalyst specific to Alphabet found.[6]
TSLA	-3.08%	Extended Wednesday's after-hours margin-miss reaction into the regular session despite beating on EPS and revenue.[6][7]
TXN	-1.81%	Gave back part of Wednesday's clean beat-and-raise after-hours gain.[6][7]

Thursday's own earnings slate, reported before the open: Lockheed Martin and Procter & Gamble led gainers (above); Union Pacific (+3.55%), Comcast (+3.44%), American Airlines (+2.98%), General Dynamics (+1.76%) and Honeywell (+1.67%) also beat. CBRE, Roper Technologies, Nasdaq Inc., Dow Inc., PulteGroup, Freeport-McMoRan, Blackstone and Valero Energy reported as well but their Thursday price moves were not individually verified this edition (Annex A). Follow-through from Tuesday/Wednesday's reporters was mixed: AT&T (+3.79%) and Netflix (+3.09%) partially rebounded from Wednesday's declines; CME Group extended its beat with a further +3.45%; Elevance Health (+2.57%) more than recovered Wednesday's dip; Danaher (-1.76%) and Thermo Fisher (-2.52%) gave back gains with no new catalyst found; Capital One eased -1.56%; United Airlines held its post-earnings gain (+0.32%); IBM was roughly flat (+0.26%) after Wednesday's after-hours margin-miss reaction. Opendoor (+3.59%) also fully reversed Wednesday's decline with no new corroborating news. AT&T's exact Wednesday close (-6.45% vs. a third-party archive's -6.1%) remains an unresolved single-source conflict (Annex A). No analyst rating action specifically dated Thursday 22 Oct could be verified this edition — flagged as a search-index-lag gap, not a confirmed absence of activity (Annex A). Separately, in New Mexico v. Meta, whether the 9 October stay of enforcement extends to Judge Francis Mathew's $25bn civil-penalty ruling (edition 47), and whether Meta has filed its formal notice of appeal, remain unconfirmed this edition — carried forward as an open thread (Annex A).[5][6][7]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Central bank	Policy rate	Last change	Next decision
Federal Reserve	3.75%–4.00%	+25bp, 16 Sep 2026, unanimous 12-0[7]	Oct 27–28, 2026, approx. 2:00pm ET decision / 2:30pm ET press conference[8]
Bank of England	3.75%	held, 17 Sep 2026, 6-3 vote[7]	Thu 5 Nov 2026[10]
Bank of Japan	approx. 1.25% (primary numeric confirmation still pending, 4th straight edition)	+25bp, 18 Sep 2026, 7-2 vote[7]	Oct 29–30, 2026[11]
Swiss National Bank	0.00%	held, 18 Jun 2026[13]	not scheduled inside this window
Norges Bank	4.50%	+25bp, 24 Sep 2026[12]	not scheduled inside this window
Riksbank	1.75% (not freshly reconfirmed this edition — primary URL 404'd)	held, 24 Sep 2026[7]	approx. 3 Nov 2026 (secondary-sourced)
Reserve Bank of Australia	4.60%	+25bp, 29 Sep 2026, unanimous[14]	approx. 3 Nov 2026 (secondary-sourced)
Banco de México	6.50%	held, 24 Sep 2026, unanimous[7]	not confirmed fresh this edition[15]

The Fed's blackout period is confirmed clean: no Fed-speaker events appear on the calendar for Oct 21 or 22, consistent with the Oct 17-29 blackout ahead of next week's decision.[8] Rate-path odds (DeFi Rate's blended Kalshi/Polymarket aggregator) moved toward hold for Oct 28 (approx. 94% hold / 6% hike, up from approx. 88% hold last edition); December's hike odds eased slightly to approx. 72-77%, though the source's own December sub-tables remain internally inconsistent as in prior editions.[9] Kalshi's own direct fetch failed again (HTTP 429, a 12th straight failure) and official CME FedWatch again timed out (an 8th straight failure) — both unavailable as primary sources this edition. Bank of Japan's Oct 29-30 meeting date is now confirmed via an explicit, dedicated direct fetch of its own schedule page, closing a thread open since edition 45; the exact current numeric policy rate remains unconfirmed via a readable primary HTML source, as the relevant Sept 2026 statement documents are PDF-only and return undecodable compressed data.[11] US government funding status is re-confirmed: H.R. 6500 funds federal agencies through 11 Dec 2026, no shutdown in effect, now via a newly re-established, cleanly fetchable whitehouse.gov URL that replaces the one that broke at edition 47.[16]

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	$99.28	+2.19%	OHLC self-consistent; no independent wire confirmation of the print found — single-sourced.[17]
Brent crude	$113.17	+4.00%	same caveat as WTI — single-sourced.[17]
Henry Hub nat gas (NGX6, Nov-26 front month)	$2.779	-0.39%	OHLC internally consistent this edition, resolving the prior multi-edition data-quality flag.[17]
Gold (futures)	$4,038.35	-2.69%	Wed 21 Oct close itself revised again on refetch ($4,142.40→$4,150.00, +0.18pp) — vendor-revision trap continues.[17]
Silver (futures)	$54.61	-5.37%	Wed 21 Oct close also revised ($57.590→$57.710, +0.21pp).[17]
Copper	approx. $14,120/tonne (COMEX-equivalent)	-2.67%	LME primary source unreachable (site outage) — first break in a 26-edition streak; COMEX futures used as a disclosed substitute, not directly comparable to an LME quote.[17]
DXY	101.57	-0.21%	
EUR/USD	1.1221	-0.11%	
GBP/USD	1.3401	+0.05%	reconciled cleanly for a 4th straight edition.
USD/JPY	156.54	-1.01%	agrees directionally with DXY for a 4th straight edition.
2-year Treasury	4.65%	-16bp	
10-year Treasury	4.96%	-17bp	
30-year Treasury	5.29%	-13bp	
2s10s spread	+31bp	-1bp	curve flattened modestly, remains positively sloped.

Treasury levels cross-checked against Trading Economics and reconciled exactly, extending the clean streak to a 13th edition.[19][20] A Kitco live-spot cross-check found no conflict this edition: gold and silver spot sat approx. 0.5-0.6% below their respective futures closes, consistent with a normal futures/spot basis rather than a sourcing conflict.[18] The session carried a genuine cross-asset divergence — oil higher and Treasury yields down sharply alongside a sharp gold/silver selloff — that this report could not pin to a single catalyst (Annex A).

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The CBOE delayed-quotes feed returned a full, clean sweep for all six series, each timestamped to Thursday's close: VIX +14.09% to 19.03, VIX9D +21.76% to 18.86, VIX3M +7.48% to 20.12, VIX6M +5.04% to 21.66, VVIX +14.16% to 107.94, SKEW +1.35% to 152.39 — all manually recomputed day-over-day changes matched the feed's own figures exactly, and neither of the feed's two known intermittent bugs (duplicated prev_day_close; percent-change dividing by current rather than prior price) was present this edition. The term structure held in contango (VIX9D < VIX < VIX3M < VIX6M) despite the sharp VIX pop, consistent with an event-driven, earnings-related vol spike rather than a systemic stress signal.[21] Dealer gamma remained fully unusable: zerogex.io stayed in its usual placeholder-dashboard mode (blank fields) and SpotGamma's dashboard confirmed as a client-side app with no server-rendered data behind its login.[24] Single-stock options-flow/skew commentary for the session's earnings reporters came up empty again, a 12th straight low-yield edition on this sub-item (Annex A). CFTC's Commitment of Traders report is confirmed unchanged since Fri 16 Oct (ES open interest 1,931,607, Asset Manager net approx. +47%/Leveraged Funds approx. -21%; NQ OI 279,515; RTY full-size OI 444,784) — the next report, covering Tue 20 Oct data, is due Fri 23 Oct 3:30pm ET, after this edition's window closes.[22] Funding: SOFR, EFFR and OBFR all fixed at 3.88% for Wednesday 21 Oct, the latest published session.[23]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Fri 23 Oct, 10:00am ET	Univ. of Michigan final Oct consumer sentiment	preliminary was 46.3, a five-month low[7]
Fri 23 Oct, 3:30pm ET	CFTC Commitment of Traders (covers Tue 20 Oct data)	first fresh print since 16 Oct; watch ES/NQ/RTY positioning after the tech selloff[22]
Tue 27–Wed 28 Oct	FOMC meeting	decision approx. 2:00pm ET Wed, press conference 2:30pm ET; hold priced at approx. 94%[8][9]
Wed 28 Oct, 9:45am ET	Bank of Canada decision	same day as the FOMC decision; reported via secondary calendar sources, not independently primary-sourced this edition (Annex A)
Thu 29–Fri 30 Oct	Bank of Japan meeting	exact current numeric policy rate still unconfirmed[11]
Fri 30 Oct, 8:30am ET	Q3 Employment Cost Index	already on the calendar as of edition 47[7]

Sector setup we take into Friday's session

- Technology/AI-infrastructure names remain the fragility point after Meta's capex-driven reversal — watch for further read-through as more AI-capex-sensitive names report.
- Defensive/staples positioning (XLP +3.31%, XLU +2.07%) outperformed on the rotation; whether it holds once the FOMC quiet period ends is worth watching.
- Fresh CFTC positioning data lands Friday afternoon — the first clean read on dealer/leveraged-fund positioning since the tech selloff began.
- An elevated but still-contango VIX (19.03) argues for continued event-driven, single-name-earnings-paced volatility rather than a broad risk-off regime, at least for now.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- Exact AP/Reuters wire closes for Thu 22 Oct 2026 — wire not indexed/fetchable by cutoff; ETF-proxy + direct-index-snapshot fallback used instead (Section 1).
- Nasdaq Composite and Russell 2000 point levels are ETF-proxy-derived (ONEQ, IWM), not a direct index snapshot.
- Official NYSE/Nasdaq closing breadth statistics — unobtainable; "6 of 11 sectors higher" used as proxy.
- AT&T's exact Wed 21 Oct close (-6.45% vs. a third-party archive's -6.1%) — unresolved single-source conflict, carried from edition 47.
- Any analyst rating/price-target action specifically dated Thu 22 Oct 2026 — not found; flagged as search-index lag, not a confirmed absence.
- Equifax's cumulative unexplained rally (approx. +18% over three sessions on an in-line print) — no catalyst found for Thursday's incremental +6.59% leg.
- MillerKnoll's +7.22% and Opendoor's +3.59% Thursday rebounds — neither has a new corroborating catalyst beyond reversing Wednesday's declines.
- Whether the 9 Oct stay of enforcement in New Mexico v. Meta applies to the $25bn judgment, and whether Meta has filed its formal notice of appeal — unconfirmed.
- CBRE, Roper Technologies, Nasdaq Inc., Dow Inc., PulteGroup, Freeport-McMoRan, Blackstone and Valero Energy's Thursday price moves — earnings reported before the open but not individually price-verified this edition.
- LME copper settlement (westmetall.com) — site unreachable (expired TLS certificate); COMEX futures used as a disclosed substitute, not directly comparable.
- Independent wire confirmation of Thursday's WTI/Brent settlement prints — single-sourced to Investing.com.
- Riksbank's current policy rate — primary URL (riksbank.se) returned 404 this edition; carried from secondary corroboration only.
- ECB's current policy rate — conflicting figures (2.00% vs. 2.40%) across sources; excluded from the policy-rate table pending a clean direct fetch.
- BoJ's exact numeric current policy rate via a readable primary HTML source — unconfirmed for a 4th straight edition; Sept 2026 statement documents are PDF-only and return undecodable compressed data.
- Bank of Canada's Wed 28 Oct decision — reported via secondary calendar sources only, not independently primary-sourced this edition.
- Options implied-vs-realized move data for Thursday's earnings reporters (Meta, Tesla, IBM, Texas Instruments) — no dated figure found.
- Single-stock options flow/skew commentary for chip/tech names — none found dated Thu 22 Oct (12th straight low-yield edition).
- A single catalyst for Thursday's gold/silver selloff alongside falling Treasury yields — not identified this edition; reported as a disclosed divergence, not explained.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] stockanalysis.com — ETF-proxy index data (SPY, DIA, ONEQ, QQQ, IWM), Thu 22 Oct 2026 close, used as index-close fallback since the AP/Reuters wire was not indexed by cutoff
- [2] fool.com — direct S&P 500 (^GSPC) and Dow (^DJI) snapshot, Thu 22 Oct 2026
- [3] SEC EDGAR — same-date 8-K filings (Meta, Lockheed Martin, Procter & Gamble, CME Group), 21-22 Oct 2026
- [4] stockanalysis.com — SPDR sector ETF price-history pages, all 11 sectors, Thu 22 Oct 2026 close
- [5] digrin.com — earnings calendar, Thu 22 Oct 2026 reporters
- [6] stockanalysis.com — single-stock history tables, Thu 22 Oct 2026 closes
- [7] Daily Economic Briefing, edition 47 (22 Oct 2026) — carried baseline figures, Wed 21 Oct closes, Meta AH-dispute context, New Mexico v. Meta $25bn ruling
- [8] federalreserve.gov — FOMC calendar and October 2026 events page
- [9] defirate.com — Kalshi/Polymarket-blended Fed rate-path odds
- [10] bankofengland.co.uk — Bank Rate and next MPC decision date
- [11] boj.or.jp — monetary policy meeting schedule page and statement-index page
- [12] norges-bank.no — policy rate
- [13] snb.ch — policy rate
- [14] Reserve Bank of Australia decision, via secondary wire reporting
- [15] Banco de México policy rate, via secondary Spanish-language sources
- [16] whitehouse.gov — H.R. 6500 signed-bill statement
- [17] Investing.com — historical-data tables for WTI, Brent, Henry Hub, gold/silver futures, DXY, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY, COMEX copper
- [18] Kitco — live spot quotes, gold and silver
- [19] home.treasury.gov — Daily Par Yield Curve, TextView, Oct 2026
- [20] tradingeconomics.com — Treasury yield secondary cross-check
- [21] cdn.cboe.com — delayed-quotes API (VIX, VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW)
- [22] cftc.gov — financial_lf.htm, Commitment of Traders
- [23] newyorkfed.org — Markets Data API, SOFR/EFFR/OBFR fixings
- [24] zerogex.io and dashboard.spotgamma.com — dealer-gamma sourcing-failure disclosure

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.